

Metrics Experimentation and GTM

1. The North Star Metric

Task Activation Velocity (TAV)

1. **Definition:** The average time elapsed from when a user completes their initial "Vent Capture" submission to when they click the [Done - Next Step] button on their first micro-step.
2. **Why It Matters:** Traditional productivity apps obsess over "Time Spent in App." For an executive dysfunction tool, success is the exact opposite. We want to *minimize* the time a user spends paralyzed or overthinking.
3. **Connection to User Value:** A dropping TAV directly correlates to breaking the biological freeze response. It proves the system effectively lowered the activation energy barrier enough for the user to take physical action.
4. **Connection to Business Value:** Shorter, highly successful "Task Rescue" moments build an intense psychological feedback loop of relief and success. This shifts the app from a passing novelty into an indispensable daily coping habit, driving long-term retention and organic word-of-mouth growth.

2. Supporting KPIs

Metric	What It Measures	Why It Matters
Micro-Step Completion Rate	The percentage of generated micro-steps marked as [Done].	Measures the accuracy of our AI decomposition engine. Low completion means steps are still too intimidating.
Calibration Trigger Rate	How frequently users hit the [Too Hard] button on an initial step.	Tracks whether our baseline AI prompts are correctly aligned with user energy states or if they are over-scoping.
Rescue Success Rate	The % of sessions where a user completes the <i>entire</i> parsed micro-sequence without abandoning the flow.	Validates the end-to-end efficacy of the session workflow from a state of panic to target completion.

7-Day/30-Day Cohort Retention	The percentage of users who return to initiate at least one Task Rescue session per week.	Proves the product is successfully forming a long-term habit for managing chronic executive dysfunction.
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3. AARRR Funnel Mapping

Funnel Stage	User Action	Metric
Acquisition	User visits the FocusBuddy landing page from a community, referral, social media post, or content channel.	Website Visitors, Sign-Up Conversion Rate, Cost Per Acquisition (CPA)
Activation	User completes their first Task Rescue session and marks at least one micro-step as completed.	First-Time Activation Rate (%)
Retention	User returns to complete additional Task Rescue sessions after their initial experience.	7-Day Retention Rate, 30-Day Retention Rate
Revenue	User upgrades to a premium plan for unlimited sessions, advanced personalization, or behavioral insights.	Free-to-Paid Conversion Rate, Monthly Recurring Revenue (MRR)
Referral	User shares FocusBuddy with friends, classmates, colleagues, or online communities.	Referral Rate, K-Factor, Invites Sent Per User

Revenue is intentionally not a primary focus during MVP validation. The initial objective is to validate whether AI-guided micro-actions successfully improve task initiation. Monetization will be explored after demonstrating consistent user activation and retention.

4. A/B Test Design: Onboarding Friction vs. Engagement

4.1 Hypothesis

If we present users with a blank single-input field rather than a mandatory cognitive state toggle, First-Time Activation Rates will increase by $\geq 20\%$ because an overwhelmed brain cannot process multi-choice self-categorization when frozen.

4.2 Control Version (A)

The UI displays a text field accompanied by 3 **mandatory button** choices: [I'm Overwhelmed], [I'm Avoiding], [I have Low Energy].

4.3 Variant Version (B)

The UI displays *only* a text field with the **placeholder**: "*Type or paste what's hanging over your head right now.*" The cognitive strategy is determined implicitly via AI sentiment analysis.

4.4 Target Users

50/50 split randomized routing across all newly registered traffic over a 14-day testing cycle.

4.5 Primary Success Metric

First-Time Activation Rate: % of new users who complete Step 1 of their first Task Rescue. The 20% lift target is benchmarked against the industry average activation gap (~15–25%) observed in onboarding-optimization studies for consumer productivity tools.

4.6 Secondary Metrics

Session latency (time on landing page before submit) · App abandonment rate before first submission.

4.7 Success Criteria

- 1. **Ship Variant B if:** lift $\geq 20\%$, $p < 0.05$, $n \geq 500$ per variant.
- 2. **Ship Variant A if:** Variant B shows no statistically significant lift or negative secondary metrics (higher bounce).
- 3. **If inconclusive ($p > 0.05$ at end of window):** extend test by 7 days with expanded traffic. If still inconclusive, default to Variant B based on lower cognitive load and flag for qualitative user interview follow-up.

5. Dashboard Plan

DASHBOARD	METRICS SHOWN	OWNER	CADENCE
Core Efficacy	Task Activation Velocity (TAV) · Calibration Trigger Rate · Micro-Step Completion Rate · Rescue Success Rate	Product & AI / Prompt Engineers	Weekly
Growth & Funnel Health	Unique sign-ups · Onboarding drop-off · First-Time Activation Rate · D1 / D14 Retention Cohorts · Referral K- Factor	Growth PM / Marketing	Weekly (first 90 days) → Bi-weekly thereafter
System Stability	API response latency · LLM error rates · Prompt failure	Core Engineering	Daily

6. Go-To-Market (GTM) Strategy

Target Audience

University students and young adult remote knowledge workers who explicitly self-identify with ADHD, neurodivergence, task paralysis, or severe burnout cycles.

Positioning Statement

For overwhelmed minds trapped in task paralysis, FocusBuddy is the zero-friction AI co-pilot that converts mental freeze into physical momentum. Unlike traditional planner apps that make you organize your day, FocusBuddy meets you in your moment of crisis and gives you just your next achievable step.

Launch Channels

1. **Organic Community Seeding:** High-value, non-promotional text and video distributions natively inside neurodivergent hubs (e.g., r/ADHD, r/productivity, dedicated Discord servers).
2. **Short-Form Video Documentation (TikTok/Reels/Shorts):** Showing raw, relatable screen recordings of moving from text panic to an absurdly easy step breakdown.
3. **Micro-Influencer Partnerships:** Collaborating with accessibility advocates and ADHD coaches to execute live testing.

Key Launch Message

"Stop planning. Stop organizing. Just tell us what you're stuck on, and let's take the first step together."

MVP Launch Checklist

- ☐ Client-side PII scrubbing regex active before any text reaches the API
- ☐ Hardcoded fallback micro-prompts live if LLM API limits are breached
- ☐ Privacy-compliant anonymous analytics connected (Mixpanel / PostHog)
- ☐ Clinical disclaimer and AI transparency label on primary UI
- ☐ Crisis helpline modal tested and verified on all devices
- ☐ Institutional pilot deck and outcome report template ready for first B2B outreach

7. Pricing & Monetization: The "Trust-First" Model

Freemium Tiered Subscription

PRICING TIERS

Free tier

₹0 / month

- ✓ Unlimited Task Rescue sessions
- ✓ Full micro-step progressive interface
- ✓ All cognitive state toggles
- ✓ Crisis intercept & safety modal
- X No session history or analytics

Premium — individual

₹399 / month

- ✓ Everything in Free
- ✓ Session history & personal progress view
- ✓ Voice input support
- ✓ Slack / WhatsApp channel integration
- ✓ Weekly AI-generated pattern summary

Institutional license B2B

₹120–180 / seat / year

- ✓ Full Premium features for all licensed users
- ✓ Admin dashboard with cohort analytics
- ✓ Quarterly outcome reports
- ✓ Crisis event reporting for welfare teams
- ✓ Dedicated onboarding & CSM support

Strategic Justification:

Neurodivergent users suffer from an extreme financial phenomenon known as the **"ADHD Tax"** consistently buying apps, organizers, and tools during a wave of hyper-focus, only to abandon them and feel immense financial guilt. Charging a mandatory upfront fee will kill user adoption. A robust, non-predatory free tier builds the safe psychological container required to prove long-term utility before asking for conversion.

The B2B per-seat pricing of ₹120–180/year is positioned deliberately below the cost of a single university counsellor session (typically ₹800–2,000 in urban India) — making the institutional ROI case straightforward. A university licensing 500 seats spends less annually than the cost of 60–90 counsellor hours.

8. Post-Launch Feedback Plan

Feedback Channels

1. **In-App Micro-Nudges:** A simple, single-tap question surfaced at the conclusion of a successful rescue session: "*Did this help you start? [Yes, broke my freeze] [No, still stuck]*".
2. **Anonymous Community Typeform:** A link embedded within the app settings for users to safely share feature requests without linking back to their identity.

Operational Feedback Lifecycle

1. **Collect:** All [Too Hard] button clicks and session abandonments are compiled into an automated latency log.
2. **Evaluate:** If a specific category of task (e.g., "Studying for Math Exams") shows a disproportionately high rate of [Too Hard] triggers, it flags that our prompting weights are failing that domain.
3. **Iterate:** Refine our prompt engineering architecture bi-weekly, adjusting step-size parameters to dynamically scale down actions even further based on these failure trends.